

Convert TSV (tab-separated values) file to CSV using Python stdlib

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Converts tab-separated values (TSV) to comma-separated values (CSV) using Python's standard library csv module.

Language

python

Category

data-processing

Command

```
python3 -c "import sys, csv; csv.writer(sys.stdout).writerows\n(csv.reader(sys.stdin, delimiter='\\t'))"
```

Explanation

The command reads TSV data from stdin, parses it with `csv.reader` using tab delimiter, and writes it to stdout using `csv.writer` with default comma delimiter. It preserves quoting and escaping rules.

Tags

python, tsv, csv, data-conversion, text-processing

Dependencies

python3

Arguments

1. **INPUT_FILE** (Optional): TSV input file (use stdin redirection)
Default: stdin
2. **OUTPUT_FILE** (Optional): CSV output file (use stdout redirection)
Default: stdout

Examples

1. `python3 -c "import sys, csv; csv.writer(sys.stdout).writerows(csv.reader(sys.stdin, delimiter='\\{t}'))" < data.tsv > data.csv` - Convert data.tsv to data.csv
2. `cat data.tsv | python3 -c "import sys, csv; csv.writer(sys.stdout).writerows(csv.reader(sys.stdin, delimiter='\\{t}'))" | head -20` - Preview first 20 rows converted

Output

```
col1,col2,col3
value1,value2,value3
```

Notes

- Handles quoted fields with tabs correctly
- Preserves newlines within quoted fields
- Works with any TSV dialect compatible with Python's csv module

Warnings

- Large files may consume memory as all rows are read into list
- Input must be valid TSV format

See Also

- [csv-to-tsv](#)

Status

reviewed

Safety

safe

Shell

posix

Platforms

linux, gnu-linux, freebsd, openbsd, netbsd

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